

Ankur Sharma

Director of Engineering | Enterprise AI, Software Platforms and Product Engineering

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Executive summary

Technology and engineering leader with 20 years of experience building enterprise software, cloud platforms, connected products and AI-native engineering capabilities. Currently a Principal Engineering Manager at Ford with functional responsibility as Head of AI for Vehicle Connectivity & Mobile. Leads Agentic AI transformation across people, process and technology; shared platform decisions affect approximately 8000 engineers, with an initial rollout spanning 10+ teams, 70+ products and approximately 250 engineers. Previously led technical strategy across 30+ global Electrification product teams and 30-40 production services supporting approximately 300,000 vehicles, 40,000 private chargers, 170,000 public chargers via partners and millions of transactions.

Leadership profile

- **People leadership:** Develop engineering managers and senior technical leaders; lead global hiring, performance, promotion, compensation, career planning and organizational effectiveness.
- **Technical judgment:** Evaluate architecture, delivery risk and build-versus-buy choices across enterprise AI, distributed systems, cloud platforms, APIs, security, reliability and developer experience; partner with Google on AI adoption and previously on Nest and home-energy integrations.
- **Strategy and prioritization:** Translate business outcomes into product and platform roadmaps, balancing near-term delivery, customer commitments, technical risk and long-term platform health.
- **Organization design:** Design multidisciplinary teams and hub-and-spoke operating models that combine shared platforms, domain ownership, reusable standards and accountable adoption; currently shaping AI CoE practices.
- **Executive communication:** Frame engineering strategy, investment, risk, operating health and transformation progress for senior leaders through business outcomes, adoption measures and portfolio trade-offs.

Technical foundation

Enterprise AI and AIOps | Agentic workflows, RAG, MCP, evaluation, governance, AI PDLC, AI SDLC, TDLC and LLMops | Cloud and platform engineering | GCP, Kubernetes, Istio, Argo CD, Temporal, Terraform, GitOps, CI/CD, Grafana, Dynatrace, Observability | Distributed systems and Data lake / ocean platforms | IoT platforms, API-led and event-driven architecture, microservices, Java, Python, Go, Kafka, Pulsar, Flink, Iceberg, PostgreSQL and MongoDB

Professional experience

Principal Engineering Manager - Enterprise Platform | Ford Motor Company

May 2025 – Present

Functional scope: Head of AI, Vehicle Connectivity & Mobile | Jan 2026 – Present

- **AI operating model:** Lead Agentic AI transformation across people, process, technology and continuous governance, with role-based agents, reusable skills, evaluation, approval controls and accountable human review; shape AI CoE practices for repeatable adoption.
- **AI lifecycle platforms:** Lead enterprise AI PDLC from ideas to Jira stories and Figma designs, AI SDLC from approved stories to service pull requests, and TDLC from telemetry and engineering metrics to proposed service or infrastructure changes.
- **AIOps portfolio:** Lead shared performance, triage, root-cause-analysis and DORA-health agents with review cycles focused on quality, reliability, performance and developer productivity.
- **Enterprise adoption:** Guide an initial rollout across 10+ teams, 70+ products and approximately 150 engineers; shared AI platform decisions affect approximately 1,300 engineers. Set a five-quarter target to train or reskill 3,000-5,000 people as adoption expands.

Functional scope: Manager, Enterprise Kubernetes Platform | May 2025 – Mar 2026

- **Product and partner leadership:** Managed platform maturity, roadmaps, SLOs and a multimillion-dollar vendor portfolio across cloud databases (Atlas MongoDB), event streaming (Streamnative Pulsar) and observability (Grafana); now partner with Google on AI ROI and adoption workshops.
- **AI engineering foundation:** Built an enterprise LLM harness with RAG, MCP servers and governed tool connectors spanning source control, delivery, work management, security, quality and observability for platform learning and commit-to-incident workflows.
- **Agentic platform migration:** Led workflows supporting migration of 50+ platforms and services from Bedrock Kubernetes infrastructure to Ford's enterprise GCP-native platform, aligning architecture, execution and operational readiness.

Principal Engineer - Electrification Cloud Products

Ford Motor Company

Jul 2021 – Apr 2025

- **Global technical leadership:** Led strategy, architecture, execution and engineering standards across 30+ product teams in North America, EMEA and APAC, with teams in the United States, Canada, Germany and India.
- **Production portfolio:** Led the architecture, launch or redesign of 30-40 customer-facing services and platforms spanning connected electric vehicles, public and private charging, grid services and home energy.
- **Customer scale:** Supported approximately 300,000 vehicles, 40,000 private chargers, 170,000 public chargers via partners across North America and Europe, and millions of transactions.
- **Portfolio decisions:** Owned build-versus-buy decisions, technology roadmaps, architecture and platform convergence across cloud connectivity, microservices, APIs, IoT and data products.
- **Organization and talent:** Interviewed 80+ candidates and hired 20+ engineers; conducted quarterly performance, talent-calibration and career-planning reviews; partnered with directors on data- and skills-informed organization changes.
- **Engineering excellence:** Served as Ford's enterprise Chaos Engineering SME, advised 15+ platforms and products, mentored senior technical leaders and reached 1,000+ participants through architecture, reliability, platform and AI learning programs.
- **Innovation:** Contributed four patent applications with two US grants covering vehicle status and camera experiences, with additional work in intelligent charging and secure vehicle connectivity.

Principal Engineer Products / Technical Lead

Altimetrik, Client - Ford Motor Company

Mar 2017 – Jun 2021

- Led the FordConnect ecosystem of 25+ Spring and Java microservices and secure vehicle-action APIs supporting Amazon Key, Alexa, Google Assistant and partner experiences.
- Directed cloud-platform migrations, CI/CD automation and OAuth2/Azure B2C security; program records report a 90% defect reduction and 50% load-time improvement.
- Coordinated global teams, delivery planning, onboarding and technical training across connected-vehicle programs.

Claims Product Architect / Technology Lead

CSC, now DXC Technology

Feb 2013 – Feb 2017

- Led product modernization, architecture and global delivery serving insurance, healthcare and energy clients across web, API and cloud platforms.
- Advised clients on technology strategy, represented product capabilities in industry settings and supported proposals that expanded long-term relationships.

Senior Software Developer / Software Developer

CSC, now DXC Technology

Jul 2006 – Mar 2012

- Led enterprise-software modules across India and US teams, reducing reported defects by more than 90% and improving data-loading performance by more than 50%.
- Built India delivery capability, designed onboarding and delivered Microsoft technology training for engineering teams.

Patents, recognition and credentials

- **Patents:** Two US grants covering Remote Vehicle Status Indicator Assembly and Method and Selfie Button for Vehicle Cameras with Flash, both granted in 2022.
- **Recognition:** Henry Ford Award for Electrification and Home Energy Management, 2025; Electrification Platform Redesign Management Award, 2023; Ford technical and innovation awards, 2017-2022; CSC Pinnacle Award, 2011.
- **Credentials:** Google Cloud Certified Professional Cloud Architect; Arize AI Architecture to Optimization; Agentic AI Professional Certification; AI Agents with MongoDB; SLO-first engineering and chaos engineering; OKR Coach.

Education

Bachelor of Engineering, Information Technology

2002–2006

Delhi College of Engineering, now Delhi Technological University

First Class | WES GPA 3.72